

Post-incident review PIR-2025-012

Data Warehouse: stale data shown to users

Contoso Platform Engineering. Fictional sample data.

Summary

On 05 March 2025, Data Warehouse experienced stale data shown to users in production (US West) for about 55 minutes. The first signal was a spike in support tickets from merchants. Investigation found that the connection pool size in a shared deployment template was lowered from 200 to 20.

Impact

Users of Data Warehouse saw stale data shown to users for about 55 minutes. The service owner, Data Platform, led the response.

Timeline

- 09:15 First signal received.
- 09:34 Incident declared and on-call team engaged.
- 09:57 Likely cause identified.
- 10:27 Mitigation applied.
- 10:58 Service confirmed healthy and incident closed.

What happened

Investigation found that the connection pool size in a shared deployment template was lowered from 200 to 20.

The relevant alert had fired repeatedly the previous week and had been muted by the on-call engineer.

What went well

Responders communicated clearly in the incident channel and the status page was updated within fifteen minutes of the incident being declared.

Actions

- Review alert thresholds so the alert only fires when action is needed.
- Load test the service at twice the expected peak before the next campaign.
- Add a circuit breaker and timeout on the upstream call.